

Autodesk softwares such as Maya. AutoCAD is the oldest of all Autodesk design softwares. It is still used for advanced 2D design as well as 3D design projects. The 2014 release of its latest version is the 28th of its kind since its inception. The less feature heavy version known as AutoCAD LT is significantly cheaper but doesn't provide any 3D modeling and rendering ability and is not useful for 3D printer based designs. The online based application version is known as AutoCAD 360 and is useful for collaborative project work, with functionality extended to mobile devices. It is functional across HTML5 browsers as well as the iOS and Android eco-systems. The discounted student version can be used for educational purposes but any assets created can't be integrated to the full version of the software unless the license is paid.

Maya was purchased by Autodesk in 2005, seven years after its initial development. It is used along with 3DS Max for graphic, animation and game design. Its advanced features allow for the virtual and print fabrication of complex geometric surfaces such as fluid materials, cloth, fur, hair and chaotic data sets. Its primary usage in 3D printing is with



3DS Max can't only design game creatures but also use those same design files to 3D print them!

respect to detailed surface modelling and is expanding as the technology develops.

FormZ

FormZ is a newer CAD program developed for 3D modeling, animation, rendering and drafting. It is capable of both surface and solid model rendering using its own proprietary code. Due to

its relative newness it is most adept at including 3D printer requirements in its program options. Its greatest strength is the accurate real world oriented physics involved in the reshaping and sculpting of designs with a fast workflow. Its significant usage outside of entertainment and animation is in product design and architecture.

Rhino3D

Rhino3D is another very popular commercial CAD program used for industrial design, architecture, product design, automotive, prototyping and reverse engineering. It is compatible with 100s of third-party plugins that further